

Activity 13: Global Tech Ambassador & Open-Source Pathway Selection

Portfolio Building | B25CS0311 | 3rd Semester B.Tech (CSE) | Track: Open-Source & Community Leadership

Part A: Program Analysis & Target Selection

Selected programs: (1) **GitHub Campus Experts** and (2) **MLH Fellowship**. They fit my open-source and community track and complement each other: GitHub Campus Experts builds leadership, speaking and campus community skills, while the MLH Fellowship builds hands-on, production-grade contribution experience. A 3rd-semester student has well over 12 months left before graduation, so both are open to me now.

Criteria	GitHub Campus Experts	MLH Fellowship
Eligibility	Active GitHub user for more than 6 months; more than 1 year left until graduation; interest in leading a campus community.	18+ years; prior coding or hackathon experience; able to commit 20-30 hrs/week.
Cycle & deadlines	Biannual cycle; next application window around February 2027 .	Rolling / batch deadlines: 31 Aug (Fall), January (Spring). Next target: January 2027 batch.
Focus	Public speaking, leadership, running campus events and tech communities.	12-week production open-source work with real engineer mentors.
Perks	Public speaking and leadership training; event funding; GitHub network.	Stipend; mentorship from real engineers; production open-source portfolio.
Fit and risk	Strong fit; I need a visible contribution history and a community plan. <i>Risk</i> : a thin GitHub profile.	Good fit for skills growth. <i>Risk</i> : the time load of 20-30 hrs/week conflicts with semester load, so it must align with a break.
Priority	Primary target (deadline furthest away, builds foundation).	Secondary target (stretch; apply when schedule allows).

Deadlines are taken from the course reference list; I will re-verify exact dates on each official site before submitting.

Part B: Readiness Assessment & Gap Analysis

Area	Current status (self-assessment)	Gap vs. requirement	Action to bridge
GitHub history	Account with coursework repos; sporadic commits.	Need consistent activity and meaningful public work for GitHub Campus Experts.	Commit at least 4 days/week; pin 3 polished repos with READMEs.
Open-source contributions	No merged PRs to external projects.	MLH expects prior coding/OSS experience.	Merge 2-3 PRs (docs/bug fixes) to 'good first issue' tasks.
Technical writing	No public posts.	Need evidence of communication skills.	Publish 2 short blog posts (Git workflow; first PR story).
Community involvement	Attendee only.	GitHub Campus Experts looks for community builders.	Host 1 campus Git/GitHub workshop; join MLH/Discord communities.
Resume / profile	Basic resume; profile README missing.	Weak first impression for reviewers.	Add profile README, update resume with projects and links.

4-Week Preparation Timeline (Week 1 starts now; submissions follow in Jan-Feb 2027 with the profile maintained in between)

Week	Focus	Concrete deliverables
Week 1	Foundation	Profile README; clean and pin 3 repos; set up a daily commit habit; choose 5 target OSS repos; update resume.
Week 2	First contributions	Fix issues and open 2 PRs (docs or small bug); join project Discord/Slack; publish blog post 1.
Week 3	Depth and community	Get PRs merged; take on one larger issue; plan and announce a campus Git/GitHub workshop; publish blog post 2.
Week 4	Draft and polish	Finalise 250-word essay; run the workshop and collect feedback; collect links as evidence; peer review application drafts; calendar the Jan (MLH) and Feb (GitHub Campus Experts) deadlines.

Part C: Drafted Application Material

Community Motivation Essay (approx. 250 words): GitHub Campus Experts / MLH Fellowship

I am a third-semester Computer Science and Engineering student, and the most important thing I have learned so far is that code becomes meaningful when other people can read it, use it and improve it. Open source is where that happens, and I want to make it a central part of my education and my campus community.

When I started programming, I learned alone. Real growth came when I began using Git properly, reading other developers' code and asking questions in public forums. I also noticed how many of my classmates are intimidated by GitHub. They worry about breaking something or about looking inexperienced. I want to change that.

Over the coming weeks I am building a contribution record: improving documentation, fixing small bugs in beginner-friendly projects, and writing about what I learn. I will also host a hands-on Git and GitHub workshop where students open their first pull request in a safe, guided setting.

I am applying to GitHub Campus Experts because I want to learn how to lead a technical community well: how to speak clearly, organise events and keep people engaged over time. I am applying to the MLH Fellowship because I want to work on real production code with experienced mentors, and to hold myself to professional standards of review, testing and collaboration.

My goal is simple: grow as an engineer, and make sure that when I do, the students around me grow with me. I would be proud to represent my campus in the global developer community.

Short-form Answers (for application form fields)

Prompt	Draft response
Why do you want to join this program?	I want structured mentorship and a platform to turn my individual learning into community impact, by contributing to real projects and helping other students begin.
What will you do on campus?	Run monthly Git/GitHub and open-source workshops, a 'first PR' help desk, and a small contributor group that adopts one beginner-friendly project each semester.
How will you measure success?	Number of students making their first merged PR, workshop attendance and repeat participation, and my own merged contributions and posts.

Self-Evaluation against Rubric

Rubric criterion	Weight	How this submission addresses it
Program Research & Analysis	30%	Two programs compared on eligibility, cycle, deadlines, focus and perks, with risk and priority.
Self-Assessment & Gap Plan	40%	Five gap areas with specific actions plus a realistic week-by-week 4-week plan with deliverables.
Drafted Application Material	30%	~250-word essay aligned to both programs, plus short-form answers.